

Proposal Rubric

Criteria	Ratings	Pts
The Basics: Minimum Requirements Determines completeness, basic specs, and fulfillment of the proposal task. If not met, evaluation is limited strictly to this category.	75 pts Near Complete Minor baseline issue, such as a small memo-format problem or one missing required element. 65 pts Partially Complete Several core requirements are missing or incomplete, such as required proposal sections, research, schedule, or visuals. 55 pts Mostly Incomplete Major requirements are missing. Submission is substantially incomplete, uses the wrong genre or project, or does not provide a workable proposal for the assigned project. 0 pts Meets Requirements All minimum requirements are met: assigned client document and proposal-memo genre, required proposal content and sections, Gantt chart, additional visual, and at least three outside sources with source documentation. Graded on remaining criteria.	75 pts
Proposal Purpose, Rationale & Persuasion Establishes the proposed project, explains why the document warrants investigation, and makes a convincing case for approval.	20 pts Meets or Exceeds Clearly establishes the proposed project and makes a convincing case for investigating the selected document. Uses specific, appropriate evidence to show the project's value without presenting preliminary concerns as final conclusions. 17 pts Almost There Project and rationale are generally clear and persuasive, but some reasoning, evidence, or explanation needs further development. 15 pts Needs Work Rationale is limited, vague, insufficiently supported, or makes conclusions that have not yet been established through investigation. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	20 pts

Criteria	Ratings	Pts
Proposed Program & Research Plan Presents a practical, specific plan for evaluating the client document.	20 pts Meets or Exceeds Presents a clear, specific, and realistic plan for evaluating the document. Explains how research and analysis will address document design and usability, plain language, accessibility, and other relevant communication concerns. 17 pts Almost There Provides a workable research and analysis plan, but some methods, resources, or connections to the communication concerns need further development. 15 pts Needs Work Plan is vague, incomplete, overly general, or does not adequately explain how the document will be researched and evaluated. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	20 pts
Audience & Client Context Demonstrates understanding of the Project Lead, client organization, and users of the client document.	15 pts Meets or Exceeds Proposal is effectively adapted to the Project Lead and demonstrates a clear understanding of the client, the recommendation report audience, and the users of the client document. Relevant needs and use contexts inform the proposed project. 13 pts Almost There Addresses the appropriate audiences and client context but needs additional development or more consistent attention to their needs and use of the document. 11 pts Needs Work Audience or client analysis is superficial, unclear, inaccurate, or insufficiently connected to the proposed project. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	15 pts

Criteria	Ratings	Pts
Qualifications & Professional Credibility Establishes relevant qualifications for completing the proposed project.	10 pts Meets or Exceeds Clearly explains relevant knowledge, experience, coursework, and/or skills that support the consultant's ability to complete the project. Establishes professional credibility without overstating qualifications. 8 pts Almost There Identifies relevant qualifications but connections to the proposed work could be clearer or more fully developed. 7 pts Needs Work Qualifications are vague, weakly connected to the project, overstated, or insufficiently developed. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	10 pts
Task Schedule & Visual Communication Uses the Gantt chart and required additional visual effectively to communicate project information.	15 pts Meets or Exceeds Gantt chart presents a clear, realistic project schedule. The additional visual is relevant and helps readers understand the project. Visuals are appropriately placed, labeled, captioned, and integrated into the proposal. 13 pts Almost There Gantt chart and additional visual generally support the proposal but have minor problems with content, scheduling, design, captions, placement, or integration. 12 pts Needs Work Schedule or visual communication is weak, unclear, unrealistic, poorly integrated, or does little to help readers understand the project. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	15 pts

Criteria	Ratings	Pts
Research & Documentation Uses credible preliminary research effectively and documents sources appropriately.	10 pts Meets or Exceeds Uses credible and relevant research to support the rationale and identify useful resources for the evaluation. Sources include appropriate standards, guidelines, research, and/or professional recommendations. Citations and source documentation are complete and consistent. 9 pts Almost There Research is generally credible and relevant but could be better integrated, more authoritative, or more clearly connected to the proposed evaluation. Documentation has minor problems. 8 pts Needs Work Research is weakly connected to the project, insufficiently credible or authoritative, poorly integrated, and/or inconsistently documented. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	10 pts
Organization, Design, Plain Language & Professional Style Presents a clear, readable, accessible, and professional workplace proposal.	10 pts Meets or Exceeds Proposal is logically organized and easy to scan. Headings, spacing, paragraphing, and visual hierarchy support readability. Writing is clear, concise, professional, and consistently uses plain-language techniques. 9 pts Almost There Organization, design, and writing are generally effective, with minor problems in clarity, hierarchy, readability, concision, or professional tone. 8 pts Needs Work Recurring problems with organization, design, wording, readability, or tone reduce the proposal's effectiveness. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	10 pts